

MEALS RFI Questions and Answers

1. Contract Structure & Awards

1. **Will FEMA make single or multiple awards under this IDIQ?** FEMA's intention is to make multiple awards under this IDIQ. If multiple, how will task orders be competed among awardees? Task orders are competed by best value to the Government.
 2. **Must vendors provide both mandatory meal types** (Reduced Sodium and Survivor Daily Rations), or can vendors bid on only one? Yes, vendors must provide both mandatory meal types.
 3. **Can vendors bid only on optional CLINs** (Commercial Meals or Short Shelf-Life Meals), or must they also provide mandatory meals? No, vendors can not only bid on Optional CLINs.
 4. **What is the guaranteed minimum and estimated contract ceiling value** for the IDIQ? To establish the IDIQ there is a guaranteed minimum of \$2,000.00; however, per task order there is a minimum of one (1) truckload. The current ceiling will be estimated further along in the acquisition process.
 5. **How will proposals be evaluated** (best value, lowest price technically acceptable, or other)? Proposals will be evaluated based on best value.
 6. **Can you give a price point?** No, we cannot give a price point.
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2. Demand Forecast & Ordering Patterns

7. **What are FEMA's estimated annual quantities by meal type** for steady-state replenishment? Reduced Sodium and Survivor Daily Ration meals annual quantities are determined by disasters supported throughout the year. However, as an estimate 4 million Reduced Sodium and 2 million Survivor Daily Rations.
8. **How frequently are delivery orders expected to occur** during steady state (monthly, quarterly, etc.)? Delivery order frequencies are determined by disasters supported throughout the year.
9. **How often have surge orders historically occurred** and what volumes were typically ordered during those events? Surge orders are determined by the scope of

the disaster and the inventory available on hand. Historically volumes have ranged from 1 million meals and up.

10. **Can FEMA issue multiple simultaneous delivery orders** to the same vendor during a disaster event? **Yes, dependent upon the duration of the disaster support.**
 11. **Will FEMA distribute surge orders among multiple vendors or expect one vendor to fulfill large volumes alone?** **FEMA can distribute surge orders among multiple vendors.**
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3. Surge Production & Delivery Requirements

12. The SOW states production and shipping must **begin within 72 hours of notification** — does this mean:

- first shipment departure within 72 hours, or
- full order shipped within 72 hours?

This means delivery is to begin at the respective location within 72 hours of delivery order award.

13. **Is the 72-hour requirement expected during weekends and federal holidays?** **Yes, as this will be during an emergency response/surge operation.**
 14. **Will FEMA provide forecast alerts or pre-event notifications** before issuing surge orders? **FEMA may issue a Request for Information to determine meal type and quantities available for emergency/surge delivery response.**
 15. **Can surge deliveries be staged at FEMA distribution centers or must they go directly to disaster sites?** **During surge requirements, deliveries are typically delivered to Incident Support Bases or other disaster sites, however, FEMA may request diversion of shipments to the Distribution Centers.**
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4. Geographic Coverage

16. **Must contractors support deliveries nationwide**, including OCONUS and territories, or can vendors propose regional coverage? **Per the Statement of Work the contractor shall have the capability to support deliveries throughout 48 contiguous states (CONUS), and other than contiguous states (OCONUS) to include the U.S. territories.**

17. **Who is responsible for ocean freight or intermodal transport** for territories such as Puerto Rico, Guam, and Hawaii? **The vendor/contractor is responsible.**
18. **Will FEMA allow subcontracted transportation providers** for remote or island deliveries? **Yes**
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5. Meal Specifications & Compliance

- The SOW **prohibits nuts**, but the SDR example menu includes **peanut butter and nut pastes**. Which requirement governs? **The Statement within the SOW governs, “Nuts are **NOT** to be included due to diverticulitis and allergy conditions.”**
19. For Reduced Sodium Meals, **must the entire meal be self-heating**, or only the entrée component? **Only the entrée component must be self-heating.**
20. **When must menus and nutritional profiles be submitted and approved**—at proposal submission, after award, or before first production? **At proposal submission**
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6. Shelf-Life Requirements

21. Several sections reference **30–36 months shelf life from manufacturing**, while others say **30–36 months remaining upon delivery**.
Which standard applies for proposal compliance? 30-36 months remaining upon delivery is the standard which applies for proposal compliance.
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7. Vendor-Managed Inventory (Optional Storage)

22. If FEMA pre-purchases inventory stored at the vendor facility:
- **Who owns the inventory risk** (spoilage, damage, expiration)? **FEMA owns the inventory and will remove the inventory prior to expiration; however, any spoilage or damage to FEMA’s inventory while stored at the vendor-managed facility are the responsibility of the vendor, and the vendor will replace the damaged/spoiled inventory.**
 - **Will FEMA pay separate storage fees**, or must they be included in meal pricing? **The storage fees have their own separate CLIN within the contract.**

8. Logistics & Transportation

23. **Should transportation costs be included in the unit meal price**, or will separate transportation pricing be evaluated? **Transportation costs have their own separate CLIN within the contract.**
24. If FEMA uses **government-provided transportation**, will vendors still be responsible for **loading and scheduling coordination**? **Yes**
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9. Systems & Reporting

25. **What EDI standards or formats must vendors use to integrate with FEMA's Logistics Supply Chain Management System (LSCMS)?** **Vendor/Contractor will undergo EDI integration compatibility training once awarded IDIQ contract.**

10. Steady State Program

26. **How do we become a partner for the steady state program?** **By obtaining an IDIQ contract with FEMA, and ensuring registration in SAM.gov (System for Award Management). With the expectation the contractor shall have the capability to deliver the various meal types during steady state and disaster response operations.**